Module-1

Introduction to Knowledge Management:

Course Structure

Meaning, Nature, Need and Objective of KM study

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Course
MS-LIS 2nd Semester
&
MS-LIS 4th Semester

Course Structure

Module 1: Introduction to Knowledge Management	(Unit 01-07)
Module 2: KM Cycle	(Unit 08-09)
Module 3: KM Models	(Unit 10-13)
Module 4: Knowledge Economy	(Unit 14-16)
Module 5: Knowledge Capture, Codification	(Unit 17-18)
Module 6: Knowledge Sharing	(Unit 19-20)
Module 7: KM Tools and Portals	(Unit 21-27)
Module 8: Role of Organisational Culture	(Unit 28-29)
Module 9: Practice	(Unit 30-32)

9 Modules
32 Units

Course Duration-
15 Weeks

3 Classes a Week-
2 Theory and 1
Practical Classes

Learning Objectives

- Understand ‘What is Knowledge Management?”
- To understand knowledge management as a **framework** for **designing an organization’s goals, structures, and processes** so that the organization can **use what it knows to learn** **and** **to create value for its customers and community**.
- To **answer** below questions-
  - What is the organizational **vision or strategy** driving the need to manage knowledge?
  - What **roles and structures** ought to be in place?
  - How to develop **processes and practices** that promote knowledge sharing and use?
  - Which **tools and platforms** can support these efforts?
- This course is **an invitation to students** to embark on an exciting and rewarding learning adventure **towards managing knowledge**.

Knowledge Management: Meaning and Definition

Knowledge management (KM) was defined as **the process of applying a systematic approach** to the **capture, structure, management, and dissemination of knowledge** throughout an organization in order **to work faster, reuse best practices, and reduce costly rework** from project to project (Nonaka and Takeuchi, 1995; Pasternack and Viscio, 1998; Pfeiffer and Sutton, 1999; Ruggles and Holtshouse, 1999)

KM: From the Business perspective

- KM is a **business activity** with two primary aspects (Barclay and Murray, 1997):
  a) Treating the **knowledge component** of business activities as an explicit concern of business **reflected in strategy, policy, and practice** at all levels of the organization; and
  b) Making a **direct connection** between an **organization's intellectual assets—both explicit (recorded) and tacit (personal know-how)—and positive business results**.
- KM is a **collaborative and integrated** approach to the **creation, capture, organization, access and use** of an **enterprise's intellectual assets**. (Grey, 1996)

KM: From the Cognitive Science or Knowledge Science perspective

- **Knowledge**—the **insights, understandings, and practical know-how** that we all **possess**—is the fundamental resource that **allows** us to **function intelligently**.
- Overtime, considerable knowledge is also **transformed to other manifestations**—such as books, technology, practices, and traditions—within organizations of all kinds and in society in general.
- These **transformations result in accumulated expertise** and, when used appropriately, increased effectiveness.
- Knowledge is one, if not **THE**, **principal factor** that makes personal, organizational, and societal intelligent behavior possible. (Wiig, 1993, pp. 38–39)

KM: From the Process/Technology perspective

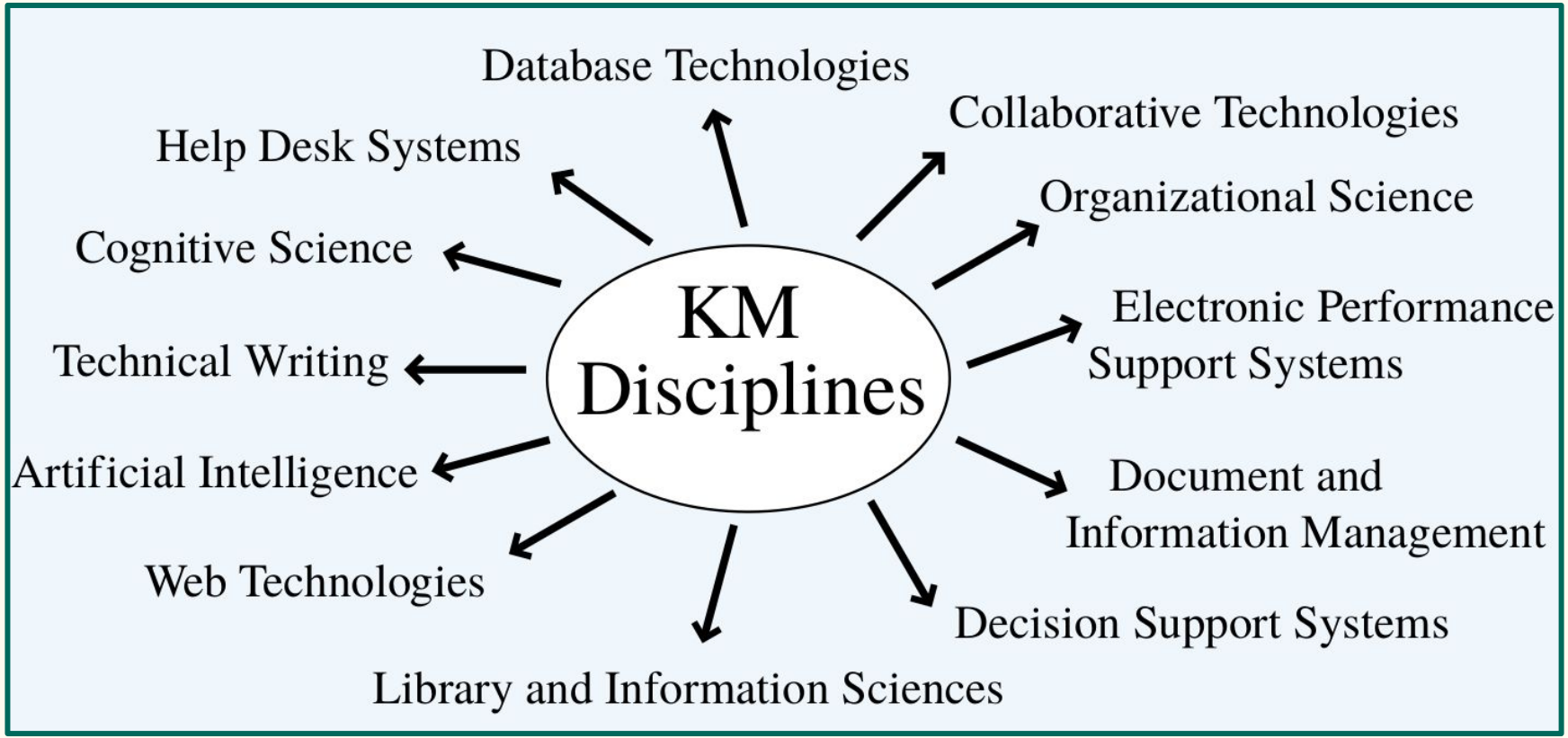
- KM is the **concept** under which **information is turned into actionable knowledge** and **made available** effortlessly in a **usable form** to the **people who can apply** it. (Information Week, Sept. 1, 2003)
- Leveraging **collective wisdom to increase responsiveness and innovation**. (Carl Frappaolo, Delphi Group, Boston, posted at http://www.destinationkm.com/articles/default.asp?ArticleID=949)
- A **systematic approach** to manage the **use of information** in order to **provide a continuous flow of Knowledge** to the **right people at the right time** enabling **efficient and effective decision making** in their everyday business. (Steve Ward, Northrop Grumman, posted at http://www.destinationkm.com/articles/default.asp?ArticleID=949)

KM: Multidisciplinary Nature

KM draws upon a **vast number of diverse fields** such as, **but not exhaustive** to:

- Organizational science.
- Cognitive science.
- Linguistics and computational linguistics.
- **Information technologies such as knowledge-based systems, document and information management, electronic performance support systems, and database technologies.**
- **Information and library science.**
- Technical writing and journalism.
- Anthropology and sociology.
- Education and training.
- Storytelling and communication studies.

KM: Multidisciplinary Nature (cont...)



KM: What is the need?

Major business drivers behind the application of KM lie in four key areas:

1. **Globalization of business.** Organizations today are **more global**—multisite, multilingual, and multicultural in nature.
2. **Leaner organizations.** We are doing more and we are doing it faster, but we also need to **work smarter as knowledge workers**, adopting an increased pace and workload.
3. **"Corporate amnesia."** **We are more mobile as a workforce**, which **creates problems of knowledge continuity** for the organization and **places continuous learning demands** on the knowledge worker. We no longer expect to spend our entire work life with the same organization.
4. **Technological advances.** We are more connected. Advances in ICT not only have made connectivity ubiquitous but have radically changed expectations. We

KM: Objectives

The main objective is to serve the Individuals, Communities, and Organizations, together.

For Individuals, KM

- Helps in jobs and save time through better decision making and problem solving.
- Builds a sense of community bonds within the organization.
- Helps people to keep up to date.
- Provides challenges and opportunities to contribute.

For Communities, KM

- Develops professional skills.
- Promotes peer-to-peer mentoring.
- Facilitates more effective networking and collaboration.
- Develops a professional code of ethics that members can follow.
- Develops a common language.

For Organizations, KM

- Helps drive strategy.
- Solves problems quickly.
- Diffuses best practices.
- Improves knowledge about products and services.
- Cross-fertilizes ideas and increases opportunities for innovation.
- Helps them to stay ahead of the competition better.
- Builds organizational memory.

KM: Components

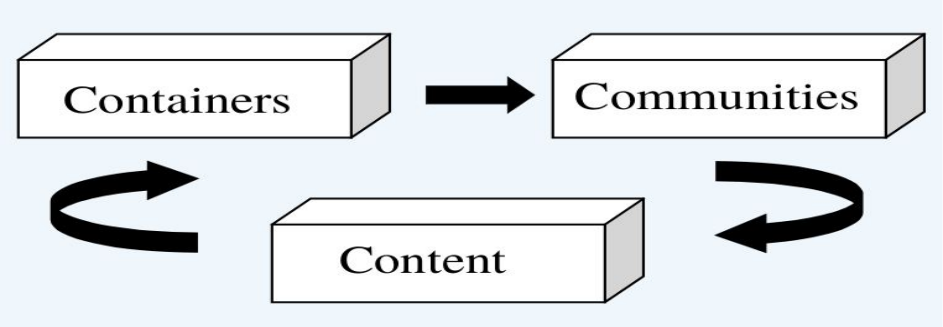
Three Major Components:

1. **Containers:** Focus on **IT systems, KM Systems**- to record what we know.

The famous slogan- "if only we knew what we know" (O'Dell and Grayson, 1998)

1. **Communities:** Focus on **People**- for not only the reuse of knowledge for greater efficiency but also for the creation of knowledge for greater innovation.

Could be phrased as - "if only we knew who knows about."



3. **Content:** Focus on how to **describe and organize content** to make it **FAIR**- **F**indable, **A**ccessible, **I**nteroperable, **R**eusable.

Paved path for concepts, like, metadata creation, content management, and knowledge taxonomies.

Better phrase could be "taxonomy before technology" (Koenig, 2002, p. 3)

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